MILITARY
SPECIFICATION

MIL-C-13273(SigC)
24 February 1954
Superseding
U. S. Army Specification
71-3145
6 November 1945

CORD, ELECTRICAL
RETRACTILE , 2, 3 AND 4 CONDUCTOR, WD-9/U, WT-2/U, WF-4/U)

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers requirements for three retractile cords designated as follows:

Cordage WD-9/U (2 conductor)
Cordage WT-2/U (3 conductor)
Cordage WF-4/U (4 conductor)

1.2 The cords covered by this specification are designed for use on communications equipment at audio frequencies,at temperatures from minus 40 degree Centigrade to plus 60 degrees Centigrade for continuous operation. It consists of two, three, or four cadmium-copper-alloy stranded conductors insulated with a natural rubber compound encased in a Buna S or Buna S and natural rubber compound jacket which is vulcanized in a helical spring coil form to produce a cord which will extend and retract freely. It is designed for extension in normal service up to five times its nominal retracted length.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards of the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids form a part of this specification:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

J-C-98 Cable and Wire, Insulated; Methods of Sample and Testing.
NN-B-591 Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood Cleated (For Domestic Shipment.)
NN-B-601 Boxes, Wood Cleated Plywood (For Domestic Shipment).
NN-B-621 Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
LLL-B-631 Boxes, Fiber, Corrugated (For Domestic Shipment).
NN-B-631 Boxes, Wood, Wirebound (For Domestic Shipment)
UU-T-111 Tape, Paper, Gummed (Kraft).

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JAN-P-105 Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment- Boxes, Wood, Cleated, Plywood.
JAN-P-106 Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment- Boxes; Wood, Nailed.

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MIL-B-107	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound (Overseas Type).
JAN-P-108	Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment-Boxes, Wood, Nailed.
JAN-P-120	Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment-Cartons, Folding, Paperboard.
JAN-P-127	Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment-Tape, Adhesive, Pressure-Sensitive, Water-Resistant.
MIL-B-131	Barrier-Material; Water-Vaporproof, Flexible.
JAN-P-133	Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment-Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard

STANDARDS

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MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking of Shipments.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Conductor.- Each conductor shall be quivalent to 511 circular mils (No. 23 AWG). It shall consist of 21 strands of No. 36 AWG tinned soft cadmium copper alloy, having a 1 percent nominal content of cadmium. It shall be bunch stranded with a lay not exceeding 3/4 inch. Prior to stranding, the elongation of individual tinned soft cadmium copper alloy strands shall be not less than 10 percent, and the tensile strength shall not exceed 55,000 pounds per square inch. Subsequent to stranding, and prior to insulating, the elongation of individual strands shall be not less than 5 percent, and the tensile strength shall not exceed 58,000 pounds per square inch.

3.2 Insulation.- The stranded conductors shall be insulated with a natural rubber compound capable of meeting the requirements specified herein.

3.2.1 Colors.- The color of the insulation on the two conductors of the two conductor cord shall be black and white, respectively. The color of the insulation on the three conductors of the three conductor cord shall be Black, White, and Red, respectively. The color of the insulation of the four conductors of the four conductor cord shall be Black, White, Red, and Green, respectively.

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3.2.2 Sunproofing wax.-The Buna S insulating compound shall contain not less than 2.5 pounds of approved sunproofing wax per 100 pounds of Buna S in the finished insulating compound.

3.2.3 Dimensions.- The diameter of the insulated conductor shall not exceed 0.080 inch, and the minimum wall thickness at any point shall be not less than 0.010 inch.

3.2.4 Physical properties.- The insulating compound shall conform to the following physical requirements before and after aging:

Unaged:

Tensile strength, minimum, p.s.i.	600
Elongation, minimum, percent	250
Set, maximum, inch	1/2

After 96 hours aging in oxygen bomb at 70 ± 1 degrees C.

Tensile strength, minimum, p.s.i.	450
Elongation, minimum, percent	175

The insulation shall be capable of stripping freely from the conductor. The compound used shall contain not more than 0.5 percent of free sulfur after vulcanization.

3.3 Cabling.- The insulated conductors shall be cabled together with a right hand lay of twist not greater than 1-1/2 inches.

3.4 Jacket.-The cabled conductors shall be jacketed with a smooth dense, Buna S compound or Buna S, natural rubber blend compound. The amount of natural rubber in the jacket compound shall not exceed 25 percent by weight of the total Buna S and natural rubber in the compound. The jacketing compound shall contain not less than 4 pounds of an approved type of sunproofing wax per 100 pounds of the totalof Buna S and natural rubber in the jacket compound After vulcanization into the construction, the average diameter of the 2-conductor cord shall be 0.220 ± 0.010 inch, and the average diameter of the 3 and 4-conductor cordage shall be 0.250 ± .010 inch. The average diameter shall be taken as the mean of the maximum and minimum diameter in any cross-section of the straight length of cord. The jacket thickness at any cross-section of cord shall be not less than 0.010 inch. The minimum jacket thickness on the straight portion of the cord shall be 0.020 inch. The jacket shall be free-stripping from the insulation.

3.4.1 Jacket physical properties.- After vulcanization, the jacket shall have the following physical properties measured on straight portions of the cord.

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3.4.1.1 Jacket physical properties before aging.- The tensile strength of the jacket shall be not less than 1200 pounds per square inch. The jacket elongation shall be not less than 175 percent.

3.4.1.2 Jacket physical properties after aging.- After accelerated aging for a period of 96 hours in an oxygen bomb at a pressure of 300, plus or minus 10 psi, and a temperature of 70, plus of minus 1 degree Centigrade, the tensile strength of the jacket shall be not less than 1000 pounds per square inch, and the elongation shall be not less than 100 percent.

3.5 Electrical cord construction.-The jacketed electrical cord shall be helical in form with adjacent turns contiguous to form a helical cord having a straight length of cord on each end tangent to the helical coil. The finished electrical cord shall have a left-hand lay in its helical section. The finished electrical cord shall have a smooth and uniform jacket. The helix shall have an overall diameter of not more than 7/8 inch for the 2-conductor cords, and shall not exceed 1-1/8 inch for 3 and 4-conductor cords. The length of the helical portions, and the length of the straight ends shall be as specified on the detail drawings.

3.6 Electrical cord extensile and retractile characteristics. The electrical cord prior to meeting any extensile and retractile requirements shall first be conditioned by extending the coiled portion of the cord to five times its retracted length and allowing it to retract freely six times. After this conditioning, the adjacent coils shall be contiguous when the cord is on a horizontal surface.

3.6.1 Stretching.-The finished cords shall be capable of being extended to four times its retracted length, 60,000 times, at a rate of not more than 40 cycles per minute. During any stretching cycle, the resistance of any conductor shall not vary more than 5 percent and the maximum resistance of any conductor at or corrected to 68 degrees F. shall not exceed the maximum value at the start of the test by more than 10 percent. After completion of the stretching test, the cordage shall return to within 20 percent of its original retracted length within one hour.

3.6.2 Extended length.-

3.6.2.1 The finished cord when suspended vertically shall be capable of extension at room temperature to at least 2-1/2 times its retracted length under a load of eight ounces for two conductor cord and ten ounces for three and four conductor cord.

3.6.2.2 The finished cord when suspended vertically shall be capable of extension at room temperature to 5 times its retracted length; if released immediately it shall return to within 10 percent of its retracted length within five minutes.

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3.6.3 Low temperature extension.- After conditioning for 20 hours at minus 40 + 2 degrees F, the finished cord shall be capable of meeting the test of 4.6.

3.6.4 Retraction after static loading.-At room temperature, the finished electrical cord shall be secured at one end and hung vertically with a weight attached to the lower end. The weight shall be such as to cause the coiled portion of the cord to extend to 250 percent of its original retracted length. After 48 hours, the weight shall be removed and the cord laid at rest and freed from restraint by tapping on a horizontal surface. Thirty minutes after being placed on the horizontal surface, the retracted length of the cord shall be not more than 110 percent of its original retracted length.

3.7 Electrical requirements.-

3.7.1 D.C. resistance.- The resistance of the stranded conductor shall not exceed 0.030 ohms per foot at 68 degrees F.

3.7.3 Dielectric strength and insulation resistance.- The electrical cord shall withstand without dielectric breakdown, a potential of 500 volts d.c. (350 volts rms a.c.) for not less than 2 seconds, and shall have an insulation resistance not less than 1000 megohms with the potential applied between each conductor and the remaining conductors connected together.

3.8 Workmanship.- All cords shall be manufactured in a thoroughly workmanlike manner.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES.

4.1 Inspection, general.- Government inspection shall consist of group A, group B, and group C inspection as specified in 4.1.1 through 4.1.4. Group B inspection shall normally be performed on lots that have passed group A inspection and on samples selected from units that have been subjected to and met group A inspection. In addition, group C inspection shall normally be performed on sample units that have been subjected to and met goup B inspection. However, the order may be varied when the Government considers it more practical to select separate samples for group B or group C inspection, or both.

4.1.1 Group A inspection.- Group A inspection shall be in accordance with Table I and Standard MIL-STD-105, Group A inspection shall be performed in any order which is satisfactory to the Government inspector.

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Table I - Government Group A inspection

Inspection or Test	Test Per	AQL Major	AQL Minor
Visual and Mechanical Inspection of Finished Wire on Reels	4.2	1%	4%
Tensile Strength and Elongation of Strands	4.3	1%	
Visual and Mechanical Inspection Of Completed Cord Assembly	4.4	1%	4%
Electrical Test of Finished Wire			
Continuity	4.5	)	
D. C. Resistance	4.6	)1%	*
Dielectric Strength and Insulation Resistance	4.7	)	
Electrical Tests of Finished Cord Assembly			
Continuity	4.5	)	
D.C. Resistance	4.6	) 1%	*
Dielectric Strength and Insulation Resistance	4.7	)	

* All electrical defects are considered major.

4.1.2 Group B inspection.- Group B inspection shall be in accordance with table II.

4.1.2.1 Order of inspection within group B.- Group B inspection shall be performed in any order which is satisfactory to the Government inspector.

4.1.2.2 Sampling procedure.- Samples shall be selected in a random manner by the Government inspector. Unless otherwise specified, inspection shall be started using level II of the specified drawing. If the number of defective sample units from a lot exceeds the acceptance number specified on the drawing the lot shall be rejected. Disposition of rejected product (sample units and lots) shall be in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-105 and 4.1.4.

4.1.2.3 Procedures in case of failure.- When a lot is rejected, the contractor shall immediately investigate the cause of failure and report to the Government inspector. The reasons for failure and the proposed corrective action shall be included in the report. If the contractor and Government inspector cannot agree on the corrective action to be taken, the matter shall be referred to the contracting officer for resolution.

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Table II - Government group B inspection

Inspection or Test	Test Par.	Sampling Plan Drawing AQL
Buna S Insulation and Jacket, Tensile Strength, Elongation and Set Extended Length	4.8 4.9	6 specimens for each test per lot 460-2 5%

4.1.3 Group C inspection.- Group C inspection shall be as specified in Table III.

4.1.3.1 Noncompliance.- If a sample unit fails group C inspection, the contractor shall immediately investigate the cause of failure and report to the Government inspector. The reasons for failure and the proposed corrective action shall be included in the report. If the contractor and the Government inspector cannot agree on the corrective action to be taken, the matter shall be referred to the contracting officer for resolution.

4.1.4 Disposition of the rejected product.-When defective sample units or rejected lots are resubmitted for acceptance, such items shall be suitably tagged or identified by equivalent means to indicate the cause of failure and means employed to correct the fault. The record shall be presented to the Government when the product is resubmitted and shall become the property of the Government.

Table III - Government group C inspection

Inspection or Test	Test Par.	Sampling Plan
Static load	4.10	1 Cord per 1000 per each test.
Retraction at -40 degrees F	4.11	
Stretch	4.12	1 Cord per 100
Oxygen bomb aging	4.13	1 Cord per 1000

4.2 Visual and mechanical inspection of finished wire on reels.- The stranded wire shall be visually inspected on reels for workmanship and miscellaneous defects before the insulating jacket is applied.

4.3 Tensile strength and elongation of strands.- The tensile strength and elongation of strands shall be tested in accordance with Method 3211 of Specification J-C-98 to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.1.

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4.4 Visual and mechanical inspection of completed cord assembly.- The completed cord assembly shall be visually inspected for workmanship and miscellaneous defects.

4.5 Continuity.- The finished cord shall be tested for continuity using a potential of not more than 10 volts. A suitable indicator such as a flashlight bulb shall be placed in the circuit.

4.6 D. C. resistance.- D. C. resistance shall be measured in accordance with Method 6021 of Specification J-C-98 to determine compliance with 3.7.1. An equivalent a.c. resistance measuring instrument may be used as an alternative to Method 6021.

4.7 Dielectric strength and insulation resistance.- An instantaneous potential of 500 volts d.c. (350 volts r.m.s) shall be applied for not less than 5 seconds between each conductor and the remaining conductor or conductors connected together. Immediately after the dielectric-strength test, the insulation resistance shall be measured with a galvanometer or other approved instrument, using a d.c. potential of not less than 125 nor more than 500 volts applied for 1 minute between each conductor and the remaining conductor or conductors connected together. If a d.c. potential of 500 volts is used for the insulation-resistance measurement, the 500-volt dielectric-strength test may be omitted. The insulation-resistance test may be terminated after 5 seconds if the galvanometer has ceased fluctuating and the reading indicates that a steady or increasing insulation-resistance value has been obtained. ~~The 500-volt dielectric-strength test and the insulation-resistance test may~~ be combined by using a megger or other approved instrument which generates 500 volts d.c. The voltage of the megger shall be continuously applied for not less than 5 seconds between each conductor and all other conductors connected together. If a correction factor is employed, the manufacturer shall demonstrate that it is accurate for the compound used. If the requirement for insulation resistance cannot be met at ambient humidity conditions exceeding 50 percent relative humidity, the sample units shall then be retested for acceptance at a relative humidity of 50 ± 10 percent.

4.8 Buna S insulation and jacket.- Conformance with the physical requirements for the Buna S insulation and jacket shall be determined by subjecting specimens removed from the completed cord to the following tests. Unless otherwise specified herein all tests shall be conducted in an atmosphere as specified in Section 7 of Specification J-C-98.

4.8.1 Tensile strength.- Tensile strength shall be determined in accordance with Method 3021 of Specification J-C-98.

4.8.2 Elongation.- Elongation shall be determined in accordance with Method 3031 of Specification J-C-98. The elongation after aging shall be based on the bench marks applied before aging.

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4.8.3 Set. Set shall be determined in accordance with Method 3161 of Specification J-C-98, except that:

(a) Bench marks shall be 2 inches apart.
(b) The test specimens shall be stretched so that the distance between bench marks is 6 inches; they shall then be released within 5 seconds.
(c) Set shall be determined 1 minute after the beginning of release.

4.9 Extended length.- The finished cord shall be tested to determine compliance with 3.6.2.

4.10 Static load.- The finished cord shall be given a static load test to determine compliance with 3.6.4.

4.11 Retraction at -40°F. - The finished electrical cord shall be placed for not less than 20 hours in a compartment maintained at a temperature of minus 40 ± 2°F. At the end of the period, a suitable coiled portion shall be extended to 4 times its retracted length without fracture of the jacket, conductor insulation, or conductors. Upon release, and while still exposed to the minus 40°F temperature, the cord shall retract to not more than 200 percent of its original length 30 seconds after being released on a horizontal surface and being freed from restraint by tapping on the surface.

4.12 Stretch.- The finished cord shall be tested to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.6.1. Compliance with these requirements shall be determined by measuring the resistance of the conductors and inspection of the jacket at the start of the test, and after 60,000 cycles are completed.

4.13 Oxygen-bomb aging.- Oxygen-bomb aging shall be performed in accordance with method 4011 of Specification J-C-98, except that the aging period shall be 96 hours, as specified in Section 3.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging.-

5.1.1 Domestic, immediate use.- The cord assembly shall be packaged in accordance with best commerical practice.

5.1.2 Domestic, limited storage.- The cord assembly shall be packaged in accordance with Method III of Specification MIL-P-116.

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5.1.3 Military, overseas.- Preserve and package the cord assembly in accordance with procedures specified in Specification MIL-P-116, and further specified in the following paragraphs:

5.1.3.1 Cord assembly, electrical.- Package each cord, determined in quantity and number from the bid request or contract, Method IA-8 as follows: Coil each cord into a coil of suitable dimensions, and tie at three places with cotton tape, securing cord terminals to the coil with the ties. Cushion each coiled cord by wrapping in flexible corrugated paper. Secure cushioning with gummed paper tape conforming to Specification UU-T-111. Inclose each cushioned cord within a close-fitting Type II, Class b bag conforming to Specification MIL-B-131. Properly seal closure. Inclose each cord within a close-fitting, folding carton or set-up box, conforming to Specification JAN-P-120 or JAN-P-133 respectively. Seal entire box closure by means of gummed paper tape, or other suitable seal.

5.1.3.2 Consolidated package.- Consolidate a suitable quantity of cord assemblies, packaged as specified in 5.1.3.1, together within a suitable style and grade fiberboard box, conforming to Specification JAN-P-108. Fill all voids with flexible corrugated paper to prevent movement. Seal entire box closure, corners and joints with water-resistant, pressure-sensitive tape, conforming to Specification JAN-P-127.

5.2 Packing.-

5.2.1 Domestic, immediate use.-The cord assemblies shall be so packed as to insure arrival at destination in satisfactory condition and in containers complying with Consolidated Freight Classification Rules, at lowest rates

5.2.2 Domestic, limited storage.- A suitable quantity of cord assemblies bearing the same stock number, shall be packed within wood-cleated fiberboard, wood-cleated plywood, nailed-wood, corrugated fiberboard or wirebound boxes, conforming to Specifications NN-B-591, NN-B-601, NN-B-621, NN-B-631 or NN-B-631. The gross weight shall not exceed 65 pounds for fiberboard boxes and 200 pounds for plywood or wood boxes. Closure shall be made in accordance with the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Military, overseas.-A suitable quantity of cord assemblies bearing the same stock number shall be packed within a wood-cleated plywood, nailed-wood or wirebound box conforming to the requirements of Specifications JAN-P-102, JAN-P-106 or MIL-B-107 respectively. The approximate gross weight of any exterior shipping container shall not exceed 150 pounds. Close the shipping container, as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

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5.2 3.1 Shipping containers shall be strapped in conformance with the requirements of the appendix of the applicable container specification only for direct shipment to ports.

5.3 Marking for shipment.- Interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with applicable provisions of MIL-STD-129

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. - Used on communication equipment at audio frequencies.

6.2 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Whether domestic or export shipment is required.
(c) Place of final inspection.

6.3 Antioxidants.- Antioxidants which have been found satisfactory for use in synthetic-rubber compounds are di-N, N^1-phenyl-para-phenylene diamine or di-N, N^1-secondary butyl-para-phenylene diamine, or both: these may be obtained as part of a proprietary chemical mixture or as a single chemical such as JZF (Naugatuck Chemical) or Tenamene 2 (Tennessee Eastman). The quantity found satisfactory for use for insulating compounds is 1.0 pound of antioxidant of which 0.5 (minimum) pound is as described above per 100 pounds of raw synthetic rubber, and for jacketing compounds 2.0 pounds of antioxidant of which 1.0 (minimum) pound is as described above per 100 pounds of raw synthetic rubber.

6.4 Acceptable sunproofing wax.- Information as to approved sunproofing wax may be obtained from the procuring activity.

6.5 Contractual requirements.- It is recommended that the following be included in the contract:

6.5.1 Additional testing.- It should be understood that additional inspection and non-destructive testing may be performed by the Government inspector when considered necessary to determine compliance with this specification and other applicable documents. The Government inspector, therefore, may withdraw materials or parts, temporarily from production for such inspection and testing, performed either at a Government laboratory or the contractor's plant.

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(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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